

028. Chapter 3 Verses 4-6

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 3.4

न कर्मणामनारम्भान्नैष्कर्म्यं पुरुषो ऽश्नुते ।
न च संन्यसनादेव सिद्धिं समधिगच्छति ॥४॥

na karmaṇām anārambhān naiṣkarmyam puruṣho 'śhnute
na cha sannyasanād eva siddhim samadhigachchhati

na—not; karmaṇām—of actions; anārambhāt—by abstaining from;
naiṣkarmyam—freedom from karmic reactions; puruṣhaḥ—a person;
aśhnute—attains; na—not; cha—and; sannyasanāt—by renunciation; eva—
only; siddhim—perfection; samadhigachchhati—attains

Man does not match the actionless state of Brahman by mere non-performance of work, nor does he attain perfection by renunciation only.

VERSE 3.5

न हि कश्चित्क्षणमपि जातु तिष्ठत्यकर्मकृत् ।
कार्यते ह्यवशः कर्म सर्वः प्रकृतिजैर्गुणैः ॥५॥

na hi kaśhchit kṣhaṇam api jātu tiṣṭhatyakarma-kṛit
kāryate hyavaśhaḥ karma sarvaḥ prakṛiti-jair guṇaiḥ

na—not; **hi**—certainly; **kaśhchit**—anyone; **kṣhaṇam**—a moment; **api**—even; **jātu**—ever; **tiṣṭhati**—can remain; **akarma-kṛit**—without action; **kāryate**—are performed; **hi**—certainly; **avaśhaḥ**—helpless; **karma**—work; **sarvaḥ**—all; **prakṛiti-jaiḥ**—born of material nature; **guṇaiḥ**—by the qualities

No one can live even for a moment without doing work.

**Everyone without his will is made to do work by the qualities
born of Prakriti.**

VERSE 3.6

कर्मेन्द्रियाणि संयम्य य आस्ते मनसा स्मरन् ।
इन्द्रियार्थान्विमूढात्मा मिथ्याचारः स उच्यते ॥६॥

karmendriyāṇi sanyamya ya āste manasā smaran
indriyārthān vimūḍhātmā mithyāchāraḥ sa uchyate

karma-indriyāṇi—the organs of action; **sanyamya**—restrain; **yaḥ**—who; **āste**—remain; **manasā**—in the mind; **smaran**—to remember; **indriya-arthān**—sense objects; **vimūḍha-ātmā**—the deluded; **mithyā-āchāraḥ**—hypocrite; **saḥ**—they; **uchyate**—are called

The man of deluded understanding who restraining the organs of the action sits contemplating the sense objects with the mind is called a hypocrite.